

Tutorial - 6

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Problem Statement : Prepare effective test cases using suitable black-box and white-box testing techniques for a given software module.

Solution : Preparing Effective test cases using black-box and white-box testing techniques

1. Introduction

- Software testing ensures that a software system works as expected and is free from defects. Test cases are systematically designed scenarios used to verify functionality, performance, and correctness.
- Testing techniques are broadly classified into:
 - Black-box testing - tests functionality without looking at internal code
 - White-box testing - tests internal logic, structure, and code paths.
- This tutorial demonstrates both techniques using a suitable software module.
- Black box testing
 - Black box testing is a software testing technique in which the tester verifies the

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functionality of an application with
knowing the internal code, structure,
implementation.

The tester focuses only on : inputs
outputs, functional requirements
It is also called : behavioral test
functional testing -

• Example

- Suppose you are testing a login
- Input : username → admin, password
- Expected output : login successful
- You do not check how the password
- validated internally
- You only check whether the correct
- displayed.

• Common black-box techniques

- i) Equivalence partitioning
- ii) Boundary value analysis
- iii) Decision table testing
- iv) State transition testing
- v) Use case testing

• Advantages

- i) No programming language required
- ii) Tests real user behaviour
- iii) Good for functional validation

• Disadvantages

- i) Internal code errors may not be detected
 - ii) Limited coverage of internal paths
- White box testing

• It is a software testing technique
the tester examines internal

and code of the application.

It is also called:

- Structural testing.
- Glass-box testing.
- Clear-box testing.

- Example:

```
if password == "1234":  
    print("login Successful")  
else:
```

```
    print("Invalid Password")
```

- In white-box testing you:
 - Check both True and False conditions
 - Ensure all lines of code execute
 - Test all logical branches.

- Common White-box Techniques

- i) Statement coverage
- ii) Branch coverage
- iii) Path coverage
- iv) Loop testing
- v) Condition coverage

- Advantages.

- i) Detects logical errors
- ii) Ensures full code coverage
- iii) Improves code quality.

- Disadvantages

- i) Requires programming knowledge
- ii) Time-consuming

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2. Software Module selected
 ⇒ Example module : Personal Expense Management module

Module name : Expense Manager
 → Functional description :

- The module allows users to manage expenses by :
- Adding new expenses
 - Viewing all recorded expenses
 - Setting and monitoring a budget
 - Calculating total and remaining balance
 - Saving / loading data from files

→ Business rules :

- i.) Expense amount must be greater than 0
- ii.) Category, date and description must be entered
- iii.) Budget must be greater than or equal to 0
- iv.) Total expenses are calculated as the sum of all entered expenses
- v.) Remaining balance = Budget - total expenses
- vi.) If total expenses exceed budget → display error message
- vii.) Expenses should be stored and retrieved from file correctly.

3. Black - box testing techniques

→ Black-box testing focuses on user's expected outputs without analyzing internal logic.

3.1 Equivalence partitioning (EP)

Input parameter : Expense amount

Partition type	Condition	Example
Valid	> 0	500
Invalid	< 0	-50
Invalid	≤ 0	0

Test cases using EP

TC ID	Input amount	Expected result
TC01	500	Expense added successfully
TC02	-50	Error: Invalid amount
TC03	0	Error: Invalid amount

2 Boundary value analysis (BVA)

Boundary around 0

TC ID	Amount	Expected result
TC04	1	Success
TC05	0	Error
TC06	-1	Error

3 Decision table testing

Conditions:

- Valid amount?
- Budget set?
- Total > budget?

Amount valid	Budget set	Exceeds budget	Expected output
Yes	Yes	No	Expense added
Yes	Yes	Yes	Alert shown
No	Yes	-	Error
Yes	No	-	Expense added (no alert)

4 State Transition testing

States:

- No expenses
- Expense added
- Budget set
- Budget exceeded

Current state	Action	Next state
No expenses	Add expense	Expense added
Expense added	Set budget	budget set
budget set	Add expense	Budget exceeded (if limit is)

4.1 White-box testing techniques
 → White-box testing checks internal logic program

4.1 Sample Pseudocode
 function addExpense (amount, budget, totalExp)
 if amount ≤ 0 :
 return "Invalid amount"

totalExpense += amount

if budget > 0 and totalExpense $>$ budget
 return "Budget exceeded alert"

return "Expense added successfully"

2 Statement coverage

Condition

amount ≤ 0

True tested

False tested

budget > 0

✓

total $>$ budget

✓

✓

✓

✓

✓

3 Path coverage

Independent paths:

1) Invalid amount

2) Valid expense (no budget)

(51)

Valid expense (within budget)
budget exceeded
Minimum 4 test cases required

Cyclomatic complexity

Decision nodes:

amount ≤ 0

budget > 0

total $>$ budget

Cyclomatic complexity $= 3 + 1 = 4$

So, minimum 4 independent test paths.

Complete test case template.

Test case ID	Description	Input	Expected output	type
TC01	Valid expense	amount=500	expense added	black-box
TC02	Invalid amount	amount=-50	error	black-box
TC03	No budget	budget=0	expense added	white-box
TC04	budget exceeded	total > budget	Alert message	both
TC05	boundary test	amount=0	error	black-box

~~cases~~